

THE RURAL LENS FUND

Financing Africa's Industrial Base

Rural Industrialisation & Value Chain Integration

Target Fund Size: USD 10 Million



USD 10M

Target Fund Size

15% IRR

Target Net Return

7 Years

Fund Life

FUND THESIS

OVERVIEW

Africa is urbanizing. But it is not industrializing.

- Rural economies power food systems, primary commodities, and labour supply.
- Yet capital is overwhelmingly urban — the cities are growing but the industrial base is not deepening.
- Africa's long-term growth will be determined not by its cities, but by the productivity and resilience of its rural base.
- The Rural Lens Fund is an impact-first fund investing in opportunities that deepen the industrialization of rural economies.

55%

of Africa
remains rural

THE PROBLEM

Rural Africa is under-structured for capital.

Fragmented Production

Disconnected systems that limit scale and efficiency.

Limited Integration

Value leakages due to poor linkages across the chain.

Low Mechanisation

Poor yields and low productivity persist across value chains.

High Shock Exposure

Weak resilience exposes capital to impairment risk.

Weak Market Access

Price inefficiencies reduce income for rural producers.

These persist because capital does not wear enough of the rural lens — resulting in high perceived risk and persistent underinvestment.

THE MARKET OPPORTUNITY

OPPORTUNITY

The continent's primary production engine

\$25B+

Annual agricultural output, largely inefficiently monetised

50%

Post-harvest losses in some value chains

2.5%

Annual population growth driving domestic food demand

Rising import substitution opportunity across processed food and commodities.

Young, willing, and available labour force across the continent.

Massive uncultivated arable land yet to be put to productive use.

The Fund will engage these opportunities with the right combinations of capital and technology, to maximise impact and achieve competitive returns.

OUR SOLUTION

We do not merely invest in rural areas. We invest with the rural lens.

01

Industrialisation

Deepen industrial activity in rural economies

02

Integration

Connect businesses to rural value chains

03

Productivity

Increase output per unit of capital deployed

04

Market Access

Create reliable demand at scale for rural output

05

Resilience

Build capacity to survive volatility and shocks

The Fund will, through this 5-part framework, invest in high-growth agricultural, renewable energy, and industrial opportunities with high impact potential.

THE RURAL LENS FRAMEWORK

FRAMEWORK

Our investment underwriting criteria

1. INDUSTRIALISATION

Does the investment deepen industrial activity?

- Processing near production zones
- Industrial farms with scale economics
- Manufacturing linked to rural inputs

2. INTEGRATION

How connected is the business to rural value chains?

- Backward integration (local sourcing)
- Forward integration (distribution)
- Traceability & supply chain visibility

3. PRODUCTIVITY

Does each dollar that is invested increase output per unit?

- Mechanisation
- Yield improvement
- Technology adoption

4. MARKET ACCESS

Does the investment create reliable demand at scale?

- Offtake agreements
- Aggregation platforms
- Cold chain & logistics solutions

5. RESILIENCE

Can this investment survive volatility?

- Diversified buyers
- FX exposure management
- Balance sheet & land security

STRATEGY OVERVIEW

Scalable businesses that anchor and integrate rural economies.

TARGET SECTORS

Agro-processing platforms

Industrial-scale farming

Logistics (aggregation, warehousing, cold chain)

Input distribution & mechanisation platforms

Rural-enabled manufacturing

INVESTMENT TYPE

● Growth / structured equity

● Select asset-backed credit

THEMATIC AREAS

● Agriculture & Agro-Allied

Core sector

● Manufacturing

Core sector

● Climate

Cross-cutting

● Gender

Cross-cutting

RETURNS

RETURNS

Targeting 20% USD IRR over a 7-year fund life

15%

Target USD IRR

7x

NGN Multiple

7 Yrs

Fund Life

RETURN DRIVERS

Margin Expansion

Productivity gains from mechanisation and tech adoption

Cost Efficiency

Integration across value chains reduces input costs

Revenue Growth

Market access improvements unlock reliable demand

Asset Appreciation

Industrial assets appreciate as operations scale

PIPELINE

Initial opportunities under evaluation

01

Agro-Processing

Processing facility with embedded sourcing network

In Review

02

Cold-Chain Logistics

Platform reducing post-harvest loss across supply chains

In Review

03

Mechanisation

Platform serving smallholder clusters with equipment access

In Review

04

Integrated Value Chain

Poultry or staple food end-to-end integration play

In Review

WHY NOW?

MARKET CONTEXT

Macro tailwinds creating a unique entry point

01

National Security Imperative

Food security now a declared national priority across African governments, driving policy and capital.

02

FX Pressure & Import Substitution

Currency depreciation makes domestic production structurally competitive for the first time.

03

Technology Reducing Barriers

Digital platforms, mobile money, and precision agri tools are lowering rural operating costs.

04

Policy Tailwinds

Increasing policy and fiscal support for local production, processing, and industrialisation.

DIFFERENTIATION

Underwriting rural exposure as a source of alpha

THE MARKET

Most investors avoid rural exposure entirely.

Those who engage treat it as an ESG obligation.

No structured underwriting framework for rural risk.

High perceived risk keeps capital away.

THE RURAL LENS FUND

- Underwrites rural exposure as a source of alpha.
- Impact and returns are complementary, not competing.
- Invests through a structured 5-part framework.
- Focuses on systems and platforms, not standalone deals.

RISKS & MITIGATION

RISK

Identifying, underwriting, and managing key risk vectors

#	Risk	Mitigation Approach
01	FX Volatility	Hedging structures and deliberate sourcing of FX-generating revenues.
02	Climate Risk	Portfolio diversification, adaptive business models, technology, and insurance.
03	Execution Risk	Phased capital deployment with clear performance milestones before tranching.
04	Market Risk	Offtake agreements and aggregation structures locked in prior to deployment.

FUND STRUCTURE

Key terms and investment parameters

Target Fund Size

USD 10,000,000

Fund Life

7 Years

Management Fee

2.5% per annum

Ticket Size

USD 200,000 – USD 2,000,000

Co-investment

Available on select transactions

Experienced, networked, and deeply committed to Africa's industrial future.

TE

ACA

Tochukwu Ezeukwu, ACA

Managing Director

13 years of experience across agribusiness finance and investment, spanning commercial banking, investment banking, international development, and impact investing. Led the facilitation of \$100 million for the USAID Feed-the-Future Nigeria Agribusiness Investment Activity (2019–2023). A Chartered Accountant with a degree in Finance, Tochukwu brings deep capital markets expertise and strong regional networks to the Fund.

\$100M+ Capital Facilitated

13 Years' Industry Experience

Chartered Accountant (ACA)

INVEST WITH THE RURAL LENS

Financing Africa's Industrial Base

GET IN TOUCH



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